



Purdue West Lafayette/Indianapolis
Department of Economics
Managerial Economics
ECON (WL) 30100
WL Fall 2026

Course Information

Meeting Information: WTHR 320

Meeting Day(s) and Time(s): TR / 1200

Instructor(s) Contact Information

Name: Ben Zou

Email: zou136@purdue.edu

Office Phone Number: (765) 496-2621

Student Consultation Hours

Tuesday 2-3 PM

Course Description

Credit Hours: 3.00. This course provides students with essential tools from intermediate microeconomic theory to support effective decision-making in business and institutional settings. By exploring fundamental economic concepts such as marginal analysis, profit maximization, cost minimization, and pricing strategies, students will enhance their strategic thinking and managerial capabilities. The course addresses key topics including consumer behavior, demand, production and costs, factor demand, market structure, and strategic behavior, equipping students to tackle complex business challenges and make sound economic decisions. By the end of the course, students will have developed the skills to determine optimal strategies in various market conditions, preparing them to succeed as informed business managers.

Prerequisites: Undergraduate level, ECON 25100, Minimum Grade of C- or Undergraduate level, ECON E2010, Minimum Grade of C- or Undergraduate level, ECON E1030, Minimum Grade of C-

Course Learning Outcomes

By the end of the course, you will be able to:

1. Analyze how individuals and firms make rational decisions in the demand and supply of goods and services.
2. Describe and interpret the equilibrium outcomes of market interactions between individuals and firms.
3. Evaluate market outcomes with regard to economic efficiency and resource allocation.
4. Apply models and theories relevant to the management of firms operating in competitive, monopolistic, and oligopolistic market structures.
5. Identify and assess various pricing strategies for firms with market power, considering the impact on both firm and market performance.
6. Use game theory to inform strategic decision-making and anticipate competitor actions in various market environments.

Learning Resources, Technology & Texts

Managerial Economics and Business Strategy

ISBN: 9781266034800

Authors: Michael R. Baye, Jeffrey T. Prince

Publisher: McGraw Hill

Edition: 10

- This is an e-book with access to the Connect software.
- Textbook and Connect software are *required*.

Brightspace learning management system (LMS)

Access the course via Purdue's Brightspace learning management system. It is strongly suggested that you explore and become familiar not only with the site navigation, but also with the content and resources available for this course. See the Student Services widget in Brightspace for Technology Resources, Academic Resources, Campus Resources, and Health and Well-Being Resources.

Assignments

Homework assignments require you to answer 10-30 questions covering material, usually from 1-2 topics/chapters. There are 7 homework assignments. There are a variety of question types including multiple choice, fill in the blank, and short answer. Each question is weighted so that each homework counts 5 points toward your final grade. The lowest 2 homework grades are dropped, so homework assignments account for total 25 points.

Grading Scale

Per the Purdue University Academic Regulations, the following grades shall be available to be assigned by the instructors and reported when they are called for by the registrar:

A+

A: Highest passing grade.

A-

B+

B

B-

C+

C

C-

D+

D

D-: Lowest passing grade; marginally passing minimal objectives of the course.

E: Conditional failure; failure to achieve minimum objectives, but only to such limited extent that credit can be obtained by examination or otherwise without repeating the

entire course. This grade represents failure in the course unless and until the record is duly changed within one semester. It cannot be improved to a grade higher than D. (See section E.) When an instructor reports a grade of E, they shall file in the departmental office a statement of what is required of the student to receive the passing grade.

F: Failure; failure to achieve minimal objectives of the course.

The student must repeat the course satisfactorily in order to establish credit in it.

Grades and Grade Reports

Header	Header
Assessment	Points
1. Assignments (best 5 of 7 assignments)	25 points
1. Midterm Exams (best 2 of 3 exams)	40 points
1. Final Exam	35 points
Total	100 points
Extra Credit Quizzes	3 points

Attendance Policy

In-person attendance is required

Course Schedule

Header	Header	Header
Week	Topic	Assessment + Notes
1: 8/25, 8/27	- Lec 0: Intro - Lec 1: Fundamentals - Chp 1	

Header	Header	Header
2: 9/1, 9/3	• Lec 2: Demand and Supply • Lec 3: Market Failures • Chp 2, Module B	
3: 9/8, 9/10	• Lec 4: Elasticity • Chp 3	
4: 9/15, 9/17	• Lec 5: Rationality & Utility • Chp 4	
5: 9/22, 9/24	• Review and Exam 1	• Exam 1 on 9/24, covering Lec 0-4 (Fundamentals)
6: 9/29, 10/1	• Lec 6: Consumer Optimization • Chp 4	
7: 10/6, 10/8	• Lec 7: Production Process & Cost • Chp 5	
8: 10/15	• Catch up	• No class on 10/13, Fall Break
9: 10/20, 10/22	• Review and Exam 2	• Exam 2 on 10/22, covering Lec 5-7 (Consumer and Firm Theory)
10: 10/27, 10/29	• Lec 8: Market Structure • Chp 8	
11: 11/3, 11/5	• Lec 9: Game Theory • Chp 10	

Header	Header	Header
12: 11/10, 11/12	- Lec 10: Oligopoly - Chp 9	
13: 11/17, 11/19	- Lec 11: Pricing Strategies - Chp 11	
14: 11/24	- Lec 12: Information Econ (optimal, not in exam) - Chp 12	No class on 11/26. Thanksgiving.
15: 12/1, 12/3	Exam 3	Exam 3 on 12/3, covering Lec 8-11 (Market Structure and Firm Behavior)
16: 12/8, 12/10 Quiet Week	Review	
Finals Week		Final Exam: TBA

Academic Integrity

Academic integrity is one of the highest values that Purdue University holds. Individuals are encouraged to alert university officials to potential breaches of this value by either emailing integrity@purdue.edu or by calling 765-494-8778. While information may be submitted anonymously, the more information is submitted the greater the opportunity for the university to investigate the concern. More details are available on Brightspace under University Policies and Statements.

I encourage you to study with one another and discuss among yourselves the material from class. However, during exams you are not permitted to use any AI, books, notes, or information from other students. The use of cell phones, smart phones, smart watches, tablets, and similar devices during exams is prohibited.

You are also prohibited from sharing material from exams with anyone, in any format, including (but not limited to) taking photos of exams, commercial websites such as Artificial intelligence platforms (like ChatGPT, Claude, or Gemini), Course Hero, Chegg or social media applications such as GroupMe, Twitch, Discord, etc.

All suspected incidents of academic dishonesty will also be referred to the Office of Student Rights and Responsibilities for further review of the student's status with the University, which may include being separated from the University. For a more thorough definition of academic dishonesty and a discussion of its repercussions, please see Purdue's [student guide for academic integrity](#). If a student is found to be cheating, the student will receive an “F” for the course and will be reported to the Office of Student Rights and Responsibilities for potential further sanctions.

AI Policy

We are at an interesting point in time with regards to the capabilities of AI. Everyone has their own opinion on the pros and cons of AI use when it comes to higher education. I will spare you my own philosophy on AI and outline below the pragmatics of using AI in this course.

I encourage the use of AI as a complement to learning. There are many tools out there (a lot which I don't know) and if it helps aid your understanding of the content and fits your learning style, I consider it a good thing. I will try and provide you with AI related resources throughout the semester to enhance your learning experience.

The Smartbook for ‘Managerial Economics and Business Strategy’ has an inbuilt AI reader tool that leverages generative AI to help students achieve a deeper understanding of the course material. I have enabled this for the entire Smartbook.

Nondiscrimination Statement

Purdue's full Nondiscrimination Policy Statement is included in the Academic Resources table on your Brightspace homepage.

This syllabus is subject to change. You will be notified of any changes as far in advance as possible via an announcement on Brightspace. Monitor your Purdue email daily for

updates.

Accessibility

Every member of our course should be able to access, use, and learn from the materials we share. This includes all course related digital content that you and I share in the course. This approach helps promote equal access for everyone at Purdue and is mandated federally by [Title II of the Americans with Disabilities Act \(ADA\)](#). We will work together to provide this access within our Brightspace course.

- My part, as the instructor, is to make sure all course materials shared to Brightspace, such as documents, slides, videos and audio, and images, meet accessibility guidelines and to assist you in making sure anything you share is accessible. If we can do anything further to support your access to and engagement with course materials, please notify me.
- Your role, as a student, is to make sure anything you post for other students to engage with is also accessible, such as peer grading, peer feedback, and discussion board posts. This expectation is built into all course assignments that require you to post to Brightspace.
- A good starting place for students and instructors is to bookmark and review the [Innovative Learning Accessibility Checklist](#) for guidance on creating accessible materials. We need to work together to make sure all materials on our course Brightspace are accessible.
- If you select materials to share on our Brightspace from Purdue Libraries catalog or databases, best practices include choosing items that:
 - Can be downloaded in full
 - Are available in EPUB or HTML formats
 - Include alternative text for written materials or captions for audio/visual content

Accommodations

Purdue University strives to make learning experiences accessible to all participants. If you anticipate or experience physical or academic barriers based on disability, you are encouraged to contact the Disability Resource Center at: drc@purdue.edu or by phone: 765-494-1247, as soon as possible.

If the Disability Resource Center (DRC) has determined reasonable accommodations that you would like to utilize in my class, you must release your Course Accommodation Letter to me. Instructions on sharing your Course Accommodation Letter can be found by visiting: [How To Use Your Course Accommodation Letter](#). Additionally, you are strongly

encouraged to contact me as soon as possible to discuss implementation of your accommodation.

Mental Health/Wellness Statement

If you find yourself beginning to feel some stress, anxiety and/or feeling slightly overwhelmed, try [Therapy Assistance Online \(TAO\)](#), a web and app-based mental health resource available courtesy of Purdue Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS). TAO is available to all students at any time by creating an account on the [TAO Connect](#) website, or downloading the app from the App Store or Google Play. It offers free, confidential well-being resources through a self-guided program informed by psychotherapy research and strategies that may aid in overcoming anxiety, depression and other concerns. It provides accessible and effective resources including short videos, brief exercises, and self-reflection tools.

If you need support and information about options and resources, please contact or see the [Office of the Dean of Students](#). Call 765-494-1747. Hours of operation are M-F, 8 a.m.-5 p.m.

If you find yourself struggling to find a healthy balance between academics, social life, stress, etc., sign up for free one-on-one virtual or in-person sessions in West Lafayette with a [Purdue Wellness Coach at RecWell](#). Student coaches can help you navigate through barriers and challenges toward your goals throughout the semester. Sign up is free and can be done on BoilerConnect. Students in Indianapolis will find support services curated on the [Vice Provost for Student Life](#) website.

If you're struggling and need mental health services: Purdue University is committed to advancing the mental health and well-being of its students. If you or someone you know is feeling overwhelmed, depressed, and/or in need of mental health support, services are available. For help, such individuals should contact [Counseling and Psychological Services \(CAPS\)](#) at 765-494-6995 during and after hours, on weekends and holidays, or by going to the CAPS offices in [West Lafayette](#) or [Indianapolis](#).

Emergency Preparedness

In the event of a major campus emergency, course requirements, deadlines and grading percentages are subject to changes that may be necessitated by a revised semester calendar or other circumstances beyond the instructor's control. Relevant changes to this course will be posted onto the course website or can be obtained by contacting the

instructors or TAs via email or phone. You are expected to read your @purdue.edu email on a frequent basis.

See [Purdue's Information on Emergency Preparation and Planning](#). This website covers topics such as Severe Weather Guidance, Emergency Plans, and a place to sign up for the Emergency Warning Notification System. I encourage you to download and review the [Emergency Procedures Guide](#).

The first day of class, I will review the **Emergency Preparedness plan for our specific classroom**. Please make note of items like:

- The location to where we will proceed after evacuating the building if we hear a fire alarm.
- The location of our Shelter in Place in the event of a tornado warning.
- The location of our Shelter in Place in the event of an active threat such as a shooting.

Student-Related Policies

The Vice President for Ethics & Compliance website includes a list of [Student Policies](#). Among those is the [Violent Behavior](#) policy, which explains that Purdue is committed to providing a safe and secure campus environment for members of the university community. Purdue strives to create an educational environment for students and a work environment for employees that promote educational and career goals. Violent behavior impedes such goals. Therefore, violent behavior is prohibited in or on any University facility or while participating in any university activity.

Grade Appeals Process

At the end of the course, after final course grades have been assigned, students who believe their grade was assigned contrary to what is outlined in the course syllabus, has been assigned arbitrarily, or has been reduced too severely due to a violation of course academic integrity policies, may submit an appeal request to have this final course grade reviewed. The University's Grade Appeal Process is outlined in the University Catalog and is also referenced on the website for the [Office of Student Rights and Responsibilities \(OSRR\)](#).

Staff in the OSRR office are able to assist in determining if a Grade Appeal is appropriate. Generally, students should not expect a grade appeal to be successful if there is a lack of information to support the appeal or if the student merely thinks that the assigned grade

is "unfair". Students must also attempt to resolve the matter informally with the course instructor prior to beginning the appeal process.

Basic Needs Program

If you are facing challenges securing basic needs such as food, housing, transportation, health services, or access to technology or childcare resources and believe this may affect your performance in the course, please contact the Office of the Dean of Students (ODOS) to help coordinate with community resources. These services vary by location. In West Lafayette, see the [Basic Needs Program](#) website, or email basicneeds@purdue.edu. To connect with a Student Support Generalist on the Indianapolis campus, contact them by phone at 765-495-7797 or email studentlifeindy@purdue.edu.

Course Evaluation

Toward the end of this semester, you will be provided with an opportunity to give feedback on this course and your instructor. Purdue uses an online course evaluation system, and I will not have access to this anonymous feedback until after final grades are submitted. You will receive an official email from evaluation administrators with a link to the online evaluation site and will receive a prompt to complete the survey when you login to Brightspace. The subject line will be: Please take 2-5 minutes to complete the survey. Check your "Junk E-mail" folder occasionally to be sure the evaluation emails were not accidentally routed there. Your participation is an integral part of this course, and your feedback is vital to improving education at Purdue University. I strongly urge you to participate in the evaluation system.